[redacted] – [redacted] for Aston 2025 submission

I ran as an [redacted] candidate for the seat of Aston in the 2025 federal election campaigning on the values of Integrity, Transparency and Accountability.
As such I truly appreciate the opportunity to make this submission to the Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters' (JSCEM) inquiry into the 2025 federal election.

- I have searched through my email inboxes as well as spam folders and was not able to find any messages informing me of this inquiry. As a candidate, I would have thought that all candidates should have been directly advised?
  I noticed a Facebook post 1 day prior to the close of submissions.

I would like to lead with, in my experience the AEC and all their representatives conducted themselves in a professional and courteous manner.
To the best of my knowledge, they enforced all the rules available to control conduct at the poling locations.

I have a fundamental question that should be applied to this process and our government when it comes to behaviour and policies...

How does this benefit the people of Australia?

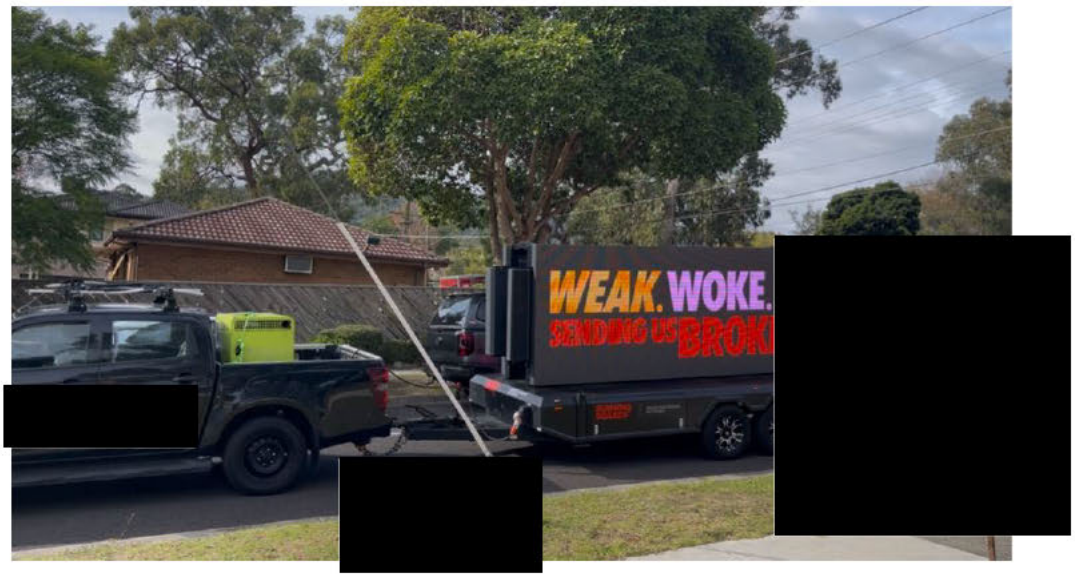
- Lying in campaigning should be illegal and it needs to be strictly and promptly enforced.
  We need truth in political messaging. If your policies are strong enough and appeal to the constituents, they will vote for you.
- Lies about candidates and party policies.
- Lies that voter's preferences were determined by the candidate or party and not by the way they filled out their ballot.
- Lies that preferences didn't count and you would waste your vote by voting for an [redacted] candidate and not a major party.
- **Lying does NOTHING to benefit the people of Australia.**

- In Aston the [redacted] Party had an excessive number of "volunteers" at multiple voting locations that we figured out during poling (and this has since been confirmed) were members of the "Exclusive Brethren".
  This was intimidating, there were lies, aggression when questioned and towards voters.
- I counted at least 14 [redacted] volunteers at one stage, compared to 2 for each of the other candidates.
- **There should be limits to active volunteers (not including the candidate) at a Polling location.**

- The [redacted] Party/Candidate and Advance Australia Party corflutes were excessive. They were placed deliberately to squeeze other candidates' material out of the high visibility area.
- **There should be limits to size and quantity of campaign messages at Poling locations.**

[redacted]

- Advance Australia Party were not running and had anti [redacted] messaging all over the electorate and even had a Mobile LED billboard drive past & then stop at the Boronia Polling booth on multiple occasions.
- The same messaging was present and placed onsite by the [redacted] team at multiple polling locations. The [redacted] Candidate "[redacted]" would not engage in a direct discussion about this with me. The "Bloody [redacted] corflutes were only moved at the location when some of the genuine [redacted] volunteers also felt it was inappropriate.
- **We need better standards on campaign messaging and only be permitted for nominated candidates.**



- As an [redacted] it was very hard to place campaign messaging. We were flooded with [redacted] corflutes, billboards, inflatable ballons on top of buildings and in businesses.

As there was fierce competition, other candidates as well as my own corflutes were being removed and replaced by [redacted] ones.

- **There should be "designated and controlled locations" with space for all candidates, with equal exposure. This would potentially help with the cost of campaigning to level the playing field (slightly).**

Once again, I thank you for the opportunity to make a submission to this Inquiry and welcome the opportunity to discuss these or any other points further.

Sincerely,

[redacted]